# Congruences for the scaled inverse series A393857

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**AI disclosure and review status.** ChatGPT (OpenAI) generated the mathematical arguments, formal proof code, and this manuscript from Dev Goyal's prompts. Dev Goyal is the sole human author and initiated the investigation. This consolidated presentation is AI-generated; independent human review of this presentation is pending. Source conjectures and prior results retain the credits given below.

**Abstract**

For the scaled inverse series A393857 we prove that every positive-index coefficient is one modulo 6. The source equation, coefficientwise interpretation of its quotient, existence, uniqueness, and the all-index proof are given explicitly.

## 1 Source equation and theorem

For a positive integer $q$, consider the normalized series $G_q$ satisfying

$$G_q\left(x - \frac{xG_q(qx)}{q}\right) = x, \qquad G_q = x + O(x^2). \tag{1}$$

The source A393857 of Paul D. Hanna is the case $q = 5$ [1]. Put $a_n = [x^n]G_5$. Its source indices start at one and $a_0 = 0$. We prove

$$a_n \equiv 1 \pmod 6 \qquad (n \geq 1).$$

All series are formal: equality and congruence are coefficientwise, and composition $U(V) = \sum_{j\geq 0} u_j V^j$ is used only when $V(0) = 0$. Every coefficient then receives finitely many contributions. A series with constant coefficient one is a multiplicative unit: if $W(0) = 0$, its inverse is $\sum_{j\geq 0}(-W)^j$. This justifies the rational comparison series below without analytic convergence or division in a residue ring.

### 1.1 Removing the apparent division

If $U(x) = \sum_{n\geq 1} u_n x^n$, define

$$L_q(U)(x) = \sum_{n\geq 1} q^{n-1} u_n x^n.$$

For a nonzero integer $q$, this is exactly $U(qx)/q$. The coefficient definition makes sense over every commutative ring, without requiring that $q$ be invertible. Equation (1) therefore means

$$G_q\big(x - xL_q(G_q)(x)\big) = x. \tag{2}$$

**Lemma 1.1.** *For any commutative ring $R$ with identity and any $q \in R$, equation (2) has a unique normalized solution in $R[[x]]$. Its construction commutes with ring homomorphisms.*

*Proof.* Write $G = x + \sum_{n\geq 2} g_n x^n$ and $V = x - xL_q(G)$. The series $V$ is normalized. The coefficient $g_n$ inside $V$ first occurs in degree $n+1$, because of the initial factor $x$. Thus the coefficient of degree $n$ in $V$ depends only on $g_2, \ldots, g_{n-1}$.

In $G(V) = V + \sum_{j\geq 2} g_j V^j$, the term $g_n V^n$ contributes exactly $g_n$ in degree $n$. The terms with $j < n$ depend only on earlier coefficients, and those with $j > n$ contribute nothing in that degree. Therefore the equation in degree $n$ has the form $g_n + P_n = 0$, with $P_n$ determined by earlier coefficients and $q$. This gives existence and uniqueness by recursion, without division. It also shows that applying a ring homomorphism to the coefficients preserves the equation; uniqueness identifies the resulting solution. □

## 1.2 The congruence and parity theorems

**Theorem 1.2.** *For every positive integer $q$,*

$$G_q(x) \equiv \frac{x}{1-x} \pmod{q+1}.$$

*In particular, every coefficient of positive degree is congruent to one modulo $q+1$.*

*Proof.* Work in $R = \mathbb{Z}/(q+1)\mathbb{Z}$, where $q = -1$. For $T = x/(1-x)$,

$$L_{-1}(T) = x - x^2 + x^3 - \cdots = \frac{x}{1+x}.$$

Hence

$$x - xL_{-1}(T) = x - \frac{x^2}{1+x} = \frac{x}{1+x},$$

and direct substitution gives

$$T\left(\frac{x}{1+x}\right) = \frac{x/(1+x)}{1 - x/(1+x)} = x.$$

Thus $T$ is the normalized solution of the reduced equation. Lemma 1.1 identifies it with the reduction of $G_q$. This argument also covers composite moduli such as six and eight. □

**Theorem 1.3.** *If $q$ is a positive even integer, then*

$$G_q(x) \equiv \sum_{j\geq 0} x^{2^j} \pmod 2.$$

*Equivalently, its coefficient of degree $n \geq 0$ is odd if and only if $n$ is a power of two. If $q$ is odd, all positive-index coefficients of $G_q$ are odd.*

*Proof.* For even $q$, reduction modulo two gives $L_q(U) = x$ for every normalized $U$: all factors $q^{n-1}$ with $n \geq 2$ vanish. Therefore the reduced equation is

$$G_q(x + x^2) = x.$$

Let $S(x) = \sum_{j\geq 0} x^{2^j}$ over $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$. The strictly increasing exponents make this a well-defined formal series. Repeated squaring in characteristic two gives $(x+x^2)^{2^j} = x^{2^j} + x^{2^{j+1}}$, and hence

$$S(x + x^2) = \sum_{j\geq 0} \left(x^{2^j} + x^{2^{j+1}}\right) = x.$$

Every term beyond the first occurs twice and cancels. By uniqueness, the reduction of $G_q$ is $S$. Its support is exactly the powers of two, including $1 = 2^0$ and excluding zero.

If $q$ is odd, then $q+1$ is even, so Theorem 1.2 already gives oddness of every positive-index coefficient. □

## 2 Application to A393857

Take $q = 5$ in Theorem 1.2. Its modulus is $q + 1 = 6$, so every positive-index coefficient has the asserted residue. Since this modulus is even, the same formula also implies that every positive-index coefficient is odd. The source congruence is valid at composite modulus 6; the proof used units with constant coefficient one and did not cancel a nonunit parameter.

## 3 Formal proof and scope

The accompanying entry file is `lean/Entries/A393857.lean`. It states the results with explicit Lean types and supplies proof terms using the complete shared implementation included in the collection. The manuscript is self-contained mathematically; the Lean entry file uses those ordinary library imports rather than duplicating the full foundation.

The entry's named theorem interfaces are listed below. The namespace of each is `FinalCollection.A393857`.

- `source_existence_uniqueness`
- `source_normalized`
- `source_equation`
- `a393857_mod_six`

The preserved dependencies also contain all supporting constructions, coefficient identities, map-compatibility results, and inverse proofs. The collection pins Lean 4.19.0 and Mathlib revision `c44e0c8ee63ca166450922a373c7409c5d26b00b`. The verification report records fresh compilation and the transitive axiom audit. Finite numerical checks corroborate the definitions and indexing; the universally quantified Lean theorems establish the all-index claims. No assertion of worldwide novelty, OEIS acceptance, publication, or completed human review follows from these checks. The prose may use elementary identities that the formal proof establishes by a different algebraic route.

## References


[1] P. D. Hanna, *A393857*, The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences. `https://oeis.org/A393857`. Source recorded in the retained proof collection, 24 October 2026.

[2] D. Goyal, *OEIS A396843 proof repository.* `https://github.com/dvgyl/oeis-a396843-proof`. Reference revision `995e55adcbe06b2a913e24f12ff73a7faf362f06`.